Tim Everard

Live Events and Production Operations Lead

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PROFILE

Live events operations leader with 15 years' experience, from theatre lighting and TV studio builds to heading Esports Operations at BLAST. I led a six-person department running large international events, with 60+ flagship events and 300+ qualifiers in 13 countries, 2,000+ freelancers and €12m+ in budgets. Hands-on across production and AV, venue and equipment arrangements, freelancer booking and contracting, budgets and invoices. I built the department's own tools for bookings, equipment and budgets, and costed and pitched new work with the product and commercial teams. I focus on making event day run smoothly for the people on site.

60+	13	€12m+	2,000+	300+
flagship events	countries	in budgets	freelancers	qualifiers

EXPERIENCE

Head of Esports Operations — Jun 2023 – Oct 2026
BLAST

- Led a six-person department running tournament operations across every BLAST ecosystem, including CS2, Dota 2, Brawl Stars, Fortnite, Rocket League and Rainbow Six
- Designed and built the department's own tools for tournament operations, event and equipment tracking, freelancer calendars, bookings and contracting, and event budgets and deadlines
- Costed and pitched new tournament work with the product and commercial teams
- Brought Team Operations into the department, so all online and offline player management and support sat with one team
- Wrote the business case for a departmental OPEX budget covering equipment renewal, software and cross-event costs
- Set technical requirements for commercial partnerships
- Rebuilt how the department works, with clearer ownership, accountability and proper documentation

KEY SKILLS

Event delivery
Event logistics, venues and equipment, site visits, bootcamps

Team leadership
Team leadership, people management, restructuring, process improvement

Budgets and costings
Budgets, pitch costings, invoices, business cases

Production and AV
Studio builds, Blackmagic, vMix, Ross Video, lighting, audio

Freelancers and vendors
Booking, contracting and payments, rotas, vendor management

Systems and tooling
Airtable, Google Workspace, Microsoft Office

Safeguarding and safety
Designated Safeguarding Lead, first aider, fire marshal

CERTIFICATIONS

First Aid at Work	2022
Safeguarding Lead (DSL)	2021
Working at Heights	2018
Moving Head Maintenance	2018
Manual Handling	2018
Fire Marshal	2018
PAT Testing	2016
IPAF	2012

References available on request.

Tournament Operations Manager

Jan 2020 – Jun 2023

BLAST · Contractor to Mar 2021, then permanent

- Managed tournament equipment and staffing budgets across CS:GO, Dota 2, Apex Legends, FIFA, Fortnite and Rainbow Six
- Booked and managed tournament operations freelancers for internal, external and online productions
- Approved equipment and staffing invoices, and decided when to hire, buy or repair tournament kit
- Arranged venues and equipment for team bootcamps
- Main tournament-level contact for FACEIT, ESIC and BLAST Premier teams
- Designated Safeguarding Lead and first aider at live events

Broadcast Freelancer

Jan 2018 – Jan 2020

Self-employed · Alongside Jam Television

- Crewed broadcasts and live events for clients including BLAST Pro Series, ESL UK and ESL Germany, BBC, Sky Sports, ITV, Immediate Media, NATS, Big Ben (WRC), Altitude Angels and Create Broadcasting
- Worked in the gallery as technical director, producer and graphics operator on live shows
- On-stage admin at esports events, and consulted on production and technical setups for clients

Broadcast and Studio Manager

Mar 2018 – Jan 2019

Jam Television · Birmingham

- Designed a multi-camera TV studio from scratch, bought the equipment, and managed installation and testing
- Controlled the studio budget, including equipment purchasing
- Hired freelancers and ran staff rotas to keep a 24-hour TV channel on air, including holiday cover and emergency call-outs
- Trained staff on studio equipment and workflows
- Managed suppliers, invoice approval and day-to-day maintenance, including software and hardware updates

Production Manager

Jul 2015 – Dec 2017

ESL UK · Leicester

- Managed production for both studios and at external events including MCM, EGX and Formula E
- Controlled production budgets and purchased studio and event equipment
- Built and set up the technical infrastructure for two ESL UK studios
- Trained crew on equipment and workflows, and ran equipment hire, installation, testing and maintenance
- Worked in the gallery as technical director, producer and graphics operator on live broadcasts
- Hired freelance crew, managed rotas and supervised internal and external staff on live shows

Senior Lighting and Event Technician

Jun 2012 – Jun 2015

Dorking Halls · Casual Technician Mar 2010 – Jan 2011

- Head of lighting for The Darkness's support act, support lighting engineer for Enter Shikari, head of audio and lighting for Lee Mack, and comedy tours with Jimmy Carr, Dara Ó Briain and Ed Byrne
- Set up and ran touring and in-house performances
- Maintained specialist kit for a theatre and two cinemas, from lighting and audio desks to 35mm and digital projectors
- Controlled the equipment and training budget, and ran in-house lighting training
- Carried out PAT testing on the venue's electrical equipment
- Covered whatever the show needed, working as audio engineer, stage hand or stage manager